

[WARNING] 12 Weeks Left in 2026 (Do This Now) EP 335

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Executive Summary

Episode 335 of Victory Talk covers Brandon Carter's "victory cyclone" success framework, seven AI tools he uses to run multi-figure businesses, burnout prevention via meditation, online fitness business monetization, and content strategy for transformation documentaries.

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Intro & Red Pill Tangent 2:10

- Episode 335 of the Victory Talk podcast, hosted by Brandon Carter (aka "Big Brandon Carter, King Keto, Gymnasium Jesus")
 - Co-hosted by "Novia DJ Chaita Grande" who moderates the live chat
- Brandon responds to a Red Pill commenter who criticized him for letting his girlfriend wear a bathing suit in a pool on a Mexico villa vacation
 - His take: those rules were made *because of* guys like him when he was young — they were not made *for* him
 - Core philosophy: **"Be the cause, not the effect."** You want to be the reason other men feel they need to guard their partners — not the one following defensive rules
 - Analogy: references the Doomsday Preppers TV show — when he was younger, his plan for the apocalypse was to rob the preppers, not become one
 - Walter White reference: "I am the danger" — reframe yourself as the threat, not the threatened
 - Clarifies he's in a committed relationship in his mid-40s and is not promoting cheating — the point is about becoming a high-value man so you operate from abundance, not scarcity

- "Don't let young red pill dudes tell a real one how to run things — it's like telling LeBron how to do a chest pass"
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Sponsor Breakdown 12:43

• **Sponsor 1 — Brandon's Live Online Fitness Training**

- Live training showing how to make an extra **\$300–\$500/day** as an online trainer using AI
- Has helped **15,000+ people** grow online fitness businesses
- Will review attendees' Instagram/social media live, answer questions, give away free AI tools
- Student testimonial — **Anna Quinn** (Dallas, TX): made **\$80,000 in 8 months** after joining High Ticket Trainer (HTT); previously made \$300 total from online coaching
- Student testimonial — **Alejandra**: made **\$9K in her first 28 days** in HTT with no prior training experience
- Student testimonial — **Justin/Will**: made **\$10,000 in one week, \$34,000 in one month**
- Key insight: lack of results often comes from lack of *belief*, not lack of discipline
 - Peter walking on water (Bible) — he could only do it after seeing Jesus do it first; proximity to proof enables belief
 - Brandon's own belief was unlocked by mentor **Elliot Hulse**, then seeing **Owen Cook (RSD Tyler)** doing \$10M/year
- Register via link in description; even if you miss the live, you get on the email list

• **Sponsor 2 — Go High Level**

- CRM Brandon has used for **8+ years** across all his businesses
- Features: email/SMS capture, campaigns, website/funnel/landing page builder, calendar, sales team management
- **30% of all online revenue** comes from email — emphasized as critical
- Recently launched MetaMuse integration
- Free 30-day trial via link in description

• **Sponsor 3 — "Thot Repellent" (comedic bit)**

- Running joke: a fictional spray being "developed" with super chat donations
 - Goal: have it ready by Halloween, which he calls "the Super Bowl for Thots"
 - Genetically engineered to only repel "hoes, gang skezers, Jezebels, scallywags, and hood rats" — regular women would just smell cologne
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Live Q&A: Super Chats Round 1 19:57

• **Dream Hopper — IBIT (Bitcoin ETF)?**

- Brandon got out of IBIT at a small loss and is sitting this one out
- Stocks have something "real" behind them; Bitcoin is "imaginary make-believe" but you can still profit

- **Pursue Excellence — CO2 monitor worth buying?**
 - High CO2 (carbon dioxide exhaled in stuffy rooms) impairs cognition
 - Brandon keeps a CO2 monitor in both offices; opens windows when levels exceed **70–80 ppm** (approximate threshold mentioned)
 - Recommends it; doesn't recall exact price but says it's not expensive
- **Pursue Excellence — How to sustain 70–80 hour work weeks without burnout?**
 - Brandon's current schedule: wakes at 8:30 AM, working within 5 minutes, stays up until 3 AM — estimates **100–120+ hours/week**
 - Key insight: **burnout comes from stress, not activity**
 - Children play all day without burning out because they're not stressed
 - **Meditation is his primary tool** for managing stress:
 - Has meditated for **15–16 years**
 - Does **two 20-minute sessions per day** (morning + afternoon), sometimes 10-minute sessions
 - Harvard study: after just **2 weeks** of consistent meditation, the amygdala (source of fight-or-flight/stress response) begins to **shrink**
 - Effect compounds dramatically over years — Brandon attributes his stress resilience almost entirely to this
 - Warning: "I meditated today and nothing happened" = like doing one bicep curl and expecting growth. It's cumulative.
 - Also: loving your work removes the "daunting" feeling of long hours
 - Brandon hates having to stop and sleep — "I just love this shit"
 - Additional factors: sleep quality, diet, biological differences
- **Mr. Out of Context — Organic marketing for local handyman business?**
 - Brandon's repeated recommendation (3rd time): **run local Facebook/Instagram ads**
 - Start with **\$5–\$10/day** in Meta Ads Manager
 - Target a **5-mile radius** — you only compete for a narrow local market segment, not the whole world
 - If you can't afford \$5/day: "Get a job. It ain't business time for you."
 - Brandon live-demos searching the **Meta Ads Library** using Claude + Scrape Creator API
 - Strategy: find ads that have been running for a long time (longevity = profitability)
 - Found: Ace Handyman's — running ads for **18 months**; Mr. Handyman from Everett running a video ad **since February**
 - "Image ads only — these guys don't know what they're doing. Throw in video ads and crush them."
 - Tasks to track for a local biz:
 - **Speed to lead**: call back within 5–10 minutes of inquiry
 - Leads per day
 - Daily outreach volume

- **Pursue Excellence — How to run AI agent without daily approval prompts?**
 - In Claude: change settings so it doesn't ask for approval — it can run automatically
 - **MetaMuse (Muse)** can also do this and is **free**
 - Brandon's personal setup: every morning, Muse creates a **personalized podcast** he listens to in the shower covering:
 - News updates
 - Technology, fitness industry news
 - Social media algorithm changes
 - Financial news and stock updates (specific sectors he chose)
 - His email inbox summary and to-do list
 - School updates for his son (pulled from school emails)
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🌀 The Victory Cyclone Framework [49:47](#)

- Core premise: two people can start in a similar place and end up in drastically different lives based on the small choices they make when things get difficult
- Brandon's credentials: 15 years helping 15,000+ people, built multiple 7-figure businesses and one 8-figure business while staying in shape and maintaining relationships

The Gap

- As the world improves (AI, technology, competition all getting better), **if you're not improving, you're getting worse by default**
 - "Five years ago none of us had ChatGPT. Now we've got super agents in our phone."
 - "If you're not getting better, you're just getting older and worse. And that's the best case scenario."
- Life gets progressively harder as you age — from infancy → grade school → high school → college → workforce → marriage → children
 - Each stage brings new challenges; you must keep pace or outperform life's increasing difficulty

The Four-Step Cycle (repeats throughout life)

Step 1 — Challenge (Recognition) - A problem or opportunity you can no longer ignore; could be fitness, work, habits, or trajectory - Examples: - Brandon's catalyst: his father died by suicide (his best friend), AND friends SV (life in prison for double homicide) and Esco (murdered in New Jersey) — forced him to recognize his path's end destination - Could be as simple as: "I don't like the trajectory my life is on" - Or external: someone laughs at you, you miss a goal, you see an opportunity untouched - You don't have to wait for something dramatic — just be honest about where you are vs. where you want to be

Step 2 — Think (Contemplate Options) - Consider your options, what makes sense, create a game plan - After his father died, during the **2008 financial crisis** (record unemployment, Lehman Brothers collapse, stock market crash, 10% unemployment), Brandon had no conventional options - Warning: **don't stay in "thinking" mode forever** - Many people spend years "getting ready to start" — watching videos, planning, waiting for

Monday - Studies show: **setting a specific start date** makes you significantly more likely to follow through - Give yourself a deadline to finish thinking and move to action

Step 3 — Choose (Intention Becomes Behavior) - Pick a path and start walking it; this is where intention becomes behavior - Only three responses available: - Move forward toward goal - Keep delaying - Revert to old habits - Only one moves you forward; and deep down, **you always know when you bitched out** — it quietly destroys confidence - Brandon's chosen path post-2008: worked **four jobs simultaneously, 12–14 hours/day, 7 days/week**: - 4 AM: trained clients in Harlem (145th Street area) - Took F train to Soho: 8-hour shift as security guard at a product store - After that: worked for friend's moving company (5 days/week) - Weekends: weekend manager at a BBQ restaurant in Astoria, Queens (12–14 hour days) - In 2009, started taking personal training **online** — a "crazy idea" at the time; was one of the pioneers

Step 4 — Test (Where You Find Out Who You Are) - Tests come in many forms: - **Delay of gratification**: can you sacrifice now for later? - **Long-term vs. short-term thinking** - **Pressure response**: do you back down or stand firm? - **Agility**: can you adjust your game plan when necessary? - **Physical tests**: cravings, slow progress, temptation when others eat badly around you - **Business tests**: a launch fails, results come slow, money takes longer than expected - **Social tests**: "You're doing too much, just be normal, just chill" - **Mediocre Mantras** — the most dangerous: - "You can take a day off, you've been working hard" - "You can eat this, you don't need to stick to your diet" - "One bite won't kill you" - These are the battle cries of the inconsistent; they rationalize giving up discipline - "You can fool everyone else. You can't fool yourself. Deep inside you know you're not living up to your potential." - Life will NOT be "an unbroken boulevard of green lights" between setting a goal and achieving it - People around you will get sick; you might hurt yourself; natural disasters, crashes, deaths — all types of emergencies will arise - The question isn't IF challenges come — it's HOW you handle them - "Grief don't pay the bills" — when his father died, Brandon just kept working 12–14 hour days for two years

The Compounding Effect

- One choice repeated over time adds up massively
 - One post doesn't grow social media; one salad doesn't get you in shape
 - Stack perfect days → stack perfect weeks → stack perfect months → **upward momentum**
 - "There's no such thing as stagnation. If you aren't getting better, the world is, and you're falling behind."
- Even failures are fine — **as long as you don't quit**
 - Brandon has had "tons of failures" over 15 years but maintained a steady stream of success because he never stopped
 - Take what you learn from failures and bring it into the next challenge

Confidence is Built, Not Found

- If you're not confident, it's probably for good reason — you haven't given yourself a reason to be
- Confidence comes from **rising to challenges, facing fear, building evidence**
- "If you really believed $X+Y+Z$ would make you \$100K this year, like you *know* it the way you know a dropped object will fall — it wouldn't take discipline to do it."
 - Lack of discipline = lack of belief

- Belief is built by **being around people who are already doing it** (Peter walking on water)

Your Action Steps

- Figure out what challenges you have right now — what needs to change?
 - Think: what options do I have?
 - Choose: what will I do TODAY to start moving toward the path?
 - Anticipate: what tests will likely arrive along the way? Have a game plan.
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Content Strategy: Makeover Madness & Content Buckets [1:25:16](#)

- **Makeover Madness** (for a 40-year-old, 240 lbs / 25% body fat sales professional wanting to become a fitness coach):
 - Start documenting your transformation journey **from day one at your heaviest**
 - Post daily: what you're doing, eating, how you're training
 - Include weekly progress photos starting from week 1 (keep showing week 1 in every comparison)
 - As you make early progress (even after losing first 10 lbs), **start giving advice** based on your own experience
 - "I lost 10 pounds in 2 weeks. Here's what I ate."
 - Brings audience along the journey — they become invested
 - You become your own **first testimonial**
 - Resonance advantage: a 240 lb guy watching will believe YOU can help him more than someone who's always been lean
 - You know the pain points on a deeper level than anyone else
 - Start picking up clients **while still in progress** — they're joining your journey
 - At the end: "I can help you do this too — work with me"
 - **Content Buckets for Transformation Documenting** (3–5 posts/day):
 - Progress posts + weight updates (anchor content)
 - **Diet**: what you're eating, meal breakdowns, what's working
 - **Training**: workouts, exercise breakdowns
 - **Sleep**: recovery content
 - **Supplements**: least important category but valid
 - **Mental/struggle content**: what's been hardest, mindset shifts
 - **Vlogs**: follow-along daily life content
 - Advice posts: frame everything through your own transformation ("Here's what worked for me")
 - Note: if enrolled in HTT (High Ticket Trainer), there's a full curriculum for this
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The 7 AI Tools That Make Brandon Money [1:34:53](#)

- Brandon has replaced most of a 40-person staff using AI — when someone leaves, he doesn't rehire; instead tests AI replacement
- Has multiplied both productivity and income

Tool 1 — ChatGPT Codex [1:36:29](#)

- Specifically the **Codex interface using the Astra 6.1 model** (not the phone app)
- Brandon's "headquarters" — runs nearly everything through it
- **Video Editing (long form + short form):**
 - Required GitHub repos (free, install by dropping URL into Codex):
 - **video-use** (search online)
 - **Hyperframes**
 - Required paid tool: **11 Labs** — transcribes videos so Codex knows when/where words are said, chops out mistakes/restarts, maps captions
 - Skills he's built over time (downloadable via link in description):
 - **Talking Head 1:** talking head reel with captions, no extra images
 - **Talking Head 2:** finds images online + places them with captions
 - **Reference Reuse:** downloads a reel from Instagram → "edit my shit just like this" → Codex replicates the style/format
 - **Three Stack Skill:** goes through B-roll folder, picks best shots, assembles a stacked-format reel
 - After approval, posts directly to Instagram, Facebook, YouTube Shorts, and TikTok
 - Short form content example took **20 minutes to edit**
 - Uses real photos (not AI-generated images) to avoid Instagram's "AI created content" label
- **Sales Call Review:**
 - Downloads sales calls automatically, reviews them, sends feedback to sales team (what they did well, what to improve)
 - Logs language patterns (hopes, dreams, objections) into copywriting skills for ad/copy use
- **IG Carousel Creation:**
 - Drops a YouTube video in → Codex extracts best points → creates slide deck
 - Accesses folder of real photos of Brandon → places text over them in 4-quadrant layout
 - Posts directly to Instagram
- **Espionage OS (Competitor Intelligence Dashboard):**
 - Built custom dashboard of all competitors' ads
 - Ranked by how long ads have been running (longevity = profitability signal)
 - Shows: the ad creative, the copy text, full video transcript, organic posts
 - Sun Tzu reference: "Know your enemy better than they know themselves"
- **Other Codex uses:** presentations/PowerPoints, managing VAs (Codex talks to people for him), YouTube ads, Instagram/Facebook ads (integrated with ads manager), website building, custom internal tools, data

analytics

- **Claw Code limitations vs Codex:** no native image generation in Claude Code, but all skills work with Claude Code too
- Cost note: Codex on top Astra 6 model burns through **\$500 credits quickly** (uses fast/ultra-fast mode); when credits run low, shifts to **\$200 Claude Code plan**

Tool 2 — Go High Level [1:57:49](#)

- CRM used for **nearly 10 years**
- Manages customers and leads, runs sales operations, email/SMS campaigns
- Build lead magnets, digital assets, websites, landing pages, funnels
- Posts to all social media platforms natively
- When Codex posts to social media, it does so **through Go High Level integration**
- Can see all DMs from social media in one place
- **Interactive Lead Magnet example — "Ripped Road Map":**
 - User inputs: height, weight, age, photo, goals
 - AI analyzes photo → estimates body fat %, pounds of fat, gives macro/game plan
 - Built **100% inside Go High Level's AI Studio** (similar to Lovable)
 - Brandon used ChatGPT to write the prompts, then built entirely via prompting
 - Automatically links to CRM workflows — no manual integration needed
 - Ends with VSSL and calendar booking link
- Brandon's Go High Level estimate: 7% body fat, 195 lbs, 14 lbs fat mass
- **Free 30-day trial via link in description** — also comes with:
 - All of Brandon's Codex skills (video editing, carousels, etc.)
 - Ripped Road Map template (editable)
 - Email sequences, text sequences, automations, all Go High Level agents

Tool 3 — Grunkbot [2:05:07](#)

- Primary use: **research and automation**
- Has its own computer; given passwords to various sites via **Agent Mail** (gives agents their own email login)
- Logs into sites, gets customer data, finds content ideas, filters daily news
- Active bots include:
 - **Stock trading bot:** Robin Hood API connected — executing trades autonomously (work in progress)
 - **Polymarket trading bot:** also a work in progress
 - **Subscription auditor:** scans and flags subscriptions to cancel
 - **Sales call reviewer:** accesses sales team's notetaker, grades calls, sends feedback via Slack ("Give Brian or Miguel feedback")
 - **Slack integration bot:** keeps the remote team updated

- **Meeting recap bot**: takes transcript from every meeting → finds action items Brandon committed to → estimates time needed → blocks calendar → assigns tasks to team members in Notion → notifies when tasks are late or due
- Grunkbot limitation: **usage caps hit quickly** even on the **\$100/month plan**; credits run out before week ends
- Would now use MetaMuse for most of this if starting fresh (but switching would be a pain)

Tool 4 — MetaMuse [2:09:36](#)

- Owned by Meta → **deep native integration with Instagram, Facebook, WhatsApp, Threads, and Meta Ads Manager**
- Great at: writing content in Brandon's voice, scheduling, research, daily accountability
- Brandon renamed his Muse "Tyrone" (changed the avatar from a furry monster to an "African-American robot")
- **Community member demo — Corey Armstrong** (men's fat loss, 300K followers):
 - "Find Corey's top 5 competitors on Instagram" → Muse went and found them
 - "Analyze their top performing reels from the last 90 days — topics, hooks, formats" → comprehensive breakdown
 - "Turn this into an artifact" → formatted competitive intelligence document
 - "DM this to Corey" → sent directly via Instagram DM
 - "Make Corey a 30-day content strategy using his brand colors" → complete strategy with his colors pulled from his profile
- **Community member demo — Kelly Nicole Fit**:
 - "Analyze her page and give me 20 lead magnet ideas" → fast, because of native Instagram integration
 - Selected: **Wedding Shred Checklist** (Kelly is engaged)
 - "Write this guide in her voice using ONLY things she's actually said on Instagram" → Muse pulled real quotes
 - Added CTA at end pointing to the link in her bio as a clickable link to her booking/VSSL page
- Cost advantage: **free tier is generous**; paid plan is **\$60/month**; Brandon has never hit the credit limit even while running bots 24/7
- Verdict: "If Muse had come out before Grunkbot, I probably wouldn't have used Grunkbot at all."

Tool 5 — Claude Code (Claw Code) [2:18:26](#)

- Cost: **\$200/month plan**
- Primary uses:
 - Content research and auditing other creators' accounts
 - Studying winning content
 - Developing new scripts — "something about the Claude models, the writing is just *better*"
 - Tracking macros (has been doing this in Claude for years)
 - Creating offers and sales assets

- Building apps and automations
- Goals and brand building
- Can do everything Codex does (including video editing)
- Main reason he still uses it: was out **before Codex**, so he's deeply embedded in certain Claude workflows
- Also serves as backup when Codex credits run out
- Limitation vs. Codex: no native image generation; interface is less refined

Tool 6 — Google Gemini [2:24:49](#)

- Primary use case: **Niche Hacking / Outlier Content Analysis**
 - Strategy: find content getting **10x views relative to creator's follower count** (outliers)
 - Tool used to find outliers: **Sorter for Instagram / TikTok** (free Chrome extension)
 - Example: a creator with 133K followers got **11 million views** on a men's fat loss video
 - Download the MP4, drop it into Gemini
 - Prompt: "This went viral. Break down why. Transcribe it. Then interview me until you have enough context to write my own version — same format, different content, no copying."
 - Gemini is the **only tool that natively accepts MP4 uploads** without requiring a third-party connector
 - Music analogy: many songs share the same key and chord progression (skeleton) but have different lyrics, melodies, tempos — that's not copying
 - "Niche hacking with 10x outliers is the fastest way to grow your following"
- Secondary uses:
 - B-roll/footage generation when you need video of yourself doing something
 - Music generation (like Suno but cheaper) — can make full songs/beats
 - Quick lookups when you don't want complexity — kept open as a fast-answer tool
 - Has great video generation tools (though other platforms have caught up)
- Note: "Other platforms have kind of surpassed it, but for video analysis it stays on my list."

Tool 7 — Connectors [2:27:23](#)

- What "brings all the tools to life" — integrations between platforms
 - Brandon's connector stack:
 - **Apple Health** → feeds calorie burn data to Claude
 - **Oura Ring** → analyzed within the Apple Health integration
 - **Claude** → tracks macros + calorie burn → calculates daily deficit or surplus → uploads to Notion database
 - **Notion** → free project management database; receives all macro/calorie data; team project tracking
 - **11 Labs** → transcription for video editing pipeline
 - **Go High Level CRM** → connected to Grunkbot, Claude, ChatGPT — can operate everything without manually logging into GHL
 - **Agent Mail** → gives AI agents their own email addresses for logins
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Live Q&A: Super Chats Round 2 2:28:42

- **Marquez** — started searching Brandon more to boost algorithm: Brandon says that's a smart move
- **Richard the Mattress Pro** — asks about mentorship for businesses outside fitness:
 - Brandon does **one-on-one mentorship** for non-fitness businesses — not publicly advertised
 - "It ain't cheap" — DM him on Instagram @KingKeto
- **Eli** — thanks Brandon for a 4-minute ab workout video that got him through two years of tough times:
 - Brandon: "That's legendary shit. Appreciate that."
- **Show schedule**: every **Tuesday and Thursday at 5 PM Eastern** (considering moving to 6 PM)
- **Reminder**: Live training **tomorrow (Wednesday) at 7 PM Eastern** — register via link in description; covers how to make \$300–\$500/day as an online trainer using AI, even with no experience or certification